THE STOLEN HACKATHON PROTOTYPE

Cybercrime Investigation - Case HS26-IR-014
Brightmoor College of Engineering (BCE) - HackSprint 2026

THE INCIDENT

Team LumenPath spent three weeks building a night-safe walking route planner. Its source code lived in a PRIVATE repository on the campus Git service (git.bce.example). On 18 November 2026 a competing team, Team Nimbus, published a teaser video for its own entry, and LumenPath's members recognised their unreleased work inside it.

Only five people had legitimate access to the repository: four LumenPath students and one faculty mentor. The HackSprint committee has collected emails, chat exports, repository records, account sessions, download records, device and network logs, and campus records.

YOUR ROLE

You are the committee's digital-forensics team. You do not touch any real system. Everything you need is in the evidence files.

OBJECTIVE

Work out what happened, in what order, who is responsible, how the prototype was transferred, and which account, device or session was involved. Be ready to explain which records are misleading.

HOW THE INVESTIGATION RUNS

- The organizer will hand you the evidence in rounds. Open only what you have been given.
- Read Investigation_Questions.pdf first. It lists what you must answer.
- At the end of each round the organizer may ask for a short checkpoint answer before releasing more evidence.
- TIME LIMIT: 35 minutes in total (about 30 minutes of investigation and 5 minutes to finalise your written answers).

RULES AND EVIDENCE STANDARD

1. All names, accounts, domains, addresses and data are fictional.
2. A conclusion only counts if you support it with evidence: cite the FILENAME plus a TIMESTAMP or RECORD ID.
3. Logs identify accounts, tokens, IP addresses and devices. They do not, on their own, identify the person who acted.
4. A suspicious fact is not the same as a connected fact. Prove links.
5. Some records are routine, outdated or misleading. Records can be incomplete: use only what the evidence supports and say plainly where you are unsure.
6. All times are IST (UTC+05:30), 24-hour. Dates are 2026.
7. Teams may divide the files, but your final answers must be your own.